

**Before you start:** close NukeStudio, Hiero and Nuke. If they are open they lock the files, and the installation may fail or be left halfway through.

## Automatic installation

Extract the whole `.zip` into any folder. The installer and the `Startup` folder have to stay together.

### Windows

- Double-click `installer_win.bat`.

### macOS

- Open Terminal in the folder where you extracted the `.zip`.
- Run:

```
bash installer_mac.sh
```

- The leading `bash` is deliberate: it works even if the `.sh` travelled inside the `.zip` without its executable permission, which fails with *Permission denied*.

## What the installer does

HieroTools is not a Nuke plugin: it **does not touch** `init.py`. It installs three separate items inside `~/ .nuke/python/startup/` (on Windows, `%USERPROFILE%\ .nuke\python\startup`):

- `LGA_HieroTools_Startup.py` — the startup script.
- `LGA_HieroTools/` — the folder holding the tools.
- `LGA_HieroTools_context.ini` — the configuration.

If a previous installation was found, it backs up the first two as `LGA_HieroTools_Startup.py.bak` and `LGA_HieroTools_backup`.

The `context.ini` is the exception: it is **always overwritten and never backed up**, because the working mode is set by the `.zip` you are installing, not by the previous installation.

## Manual installation

If you would rather do it by hand, or the installer fails, copy the three items from the `Startup` folder into `~/ .nuke/python/startup/`. There is no line to add to `init.py`.

## Optional: hide the console messages

At startup, Nuke Studio prints a line `Can't restore panel 'com.legadrop.LGA_HieroTools' because it hasn't been registered.` in the console for each HieroTools panel. It is not an error: the panels end up in place anyway. It happens because Nuke Studio restores the saved workspace before HieroTools loads.

To hide them, add this line to the `init.py` of your `.nuke` folder (if the file does not exist, create it with `import nuke` on the first line):

```
nuke.pluginAddPath("./Python/Startup/LGA_HieroTools/LGA_NKS_NukeInit")
```

The installer does not add it: it is the only manual step, and HieroTools works the same without it.

Full documentation for every tool, and updates, at [github.com/legandrop/LGA\\_HieroTools](https://github.com/legandrop/LGA_HieroTools)